

Mobile Watch: This month in mobility

Not much has changed in the world of mobiles and associated services since we met last in August, except in terms of expectations. Devices with Windows Phone 8 (and Windows 8 in tandem) and those with an Android 4.1 Jelly Bean update in their future are currently ruling the public consciousness, preventing unwary expenditure into dated technologies, when the next-generation of two platforms is nigh, yet

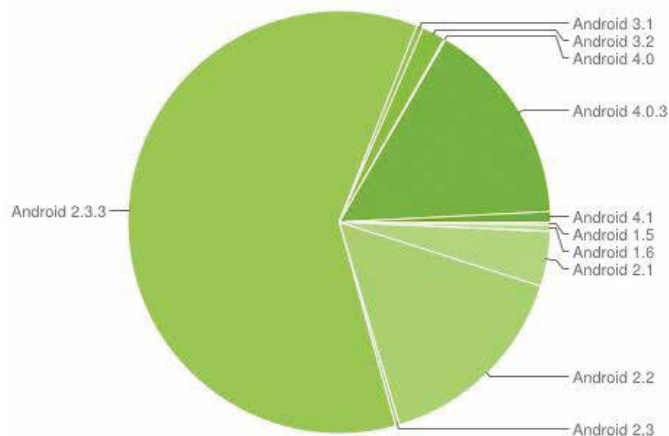
unsure, or in some cases (like Mango and WP8), disappointingly unavailable.

Jelly Bean is an obvious attempt by Google to make Android natively as touch-friendly, intuitive, and (in the minds of consumers) as Siri voice-capable as Apple's iOS. It also brings interface changes, such as detailed and interactive notifications (giving Live Tiles a run for their money), better widgets and groupings, voice dictation and typing, and a better native camera app.

While Jelly Bean may just make Android as good as iOS and iOS devices, the ecosystem is always in question – can Google Play and Google Drive compete with iTunes and iCloud? The question is still hard to answer, without easily available Jelly Bean devices to test, the iOS 6 update pending, and the still mysterious future availability of an Android 4.1 update for Gingerbread and ICS devices.

Version	Codename	API Level	Distribution
1.5	Cupcake	3	0.2%
1.6	Donut	4	0.5%
2.1	Eclair	7	4.2%
2.2	Froyo	8	15.5%
2.3 - 2.3.2	Gingerbread	9	0.3%
2.3.3 - 2.3.7		10	60.3%
3.1	Honeycomb	12	0.5%
3.2		13	1.8%
4.0 - 4.0.2	Ice Cream Sandwich	14	0.1%
4.0.3 - 4.0.4		15	15.8%
4.1	Jelly Bean	16	0.8%

Android Distribution Chart



Android Chart

Current state of Android

As of now, Android 4.0 ICS has grown to a 16 per cent share, with Jelly Bean occupying just 0.8 percent. As of August 1, 2012, Gingerbread is still the most popular of the Android operating systems available in the market, occupying more than 60 per cent of the market. Fragmentation is still a truism for Android, it seems.

Will Jelly Bean help? When will it arrive?

So far, only the Galaxy Nexus (and Nexus 7) officially run Jelly Bean. Manufacturers like ASUS, HTC, Samsung have



Jelly Bean notifications / widgets

detailed ICS upgrades for some of their devices without real timelines (in some cases strangely leaving out devices, like the HTC One V) and the recently announced Karbonn Smart Tab 1 and 2 tablet will also get Jelly Bean sometime in the near future. As we said, the future of the incremental update to Jelly Bean hitting even Ice Cream Sandwich devices is so uncertain, that consumers can almost be sure their Gingerbread devices have been left out of the loop.

None of this has daunted Indian players from launching a variety of ICS and Gingerbread devices, with promised incremental updates in most cases, ranging from budget smartphones to tablets.

Apple's iPhone 5

Amidst all these hopeful dreams, lies the next-generation of the Android nemesis – iOS and the iPhone. For now, rumours place the official appearance of the iPhone 5 around the second week of September. Expectations couldn't be higher – just what will Apple to do to innovate their offering – iOS 6 has already been unveiled, will the hardware rock Android's world?

For now, industry speculations suggests Apple would not be doing anything very revolutionary with the iPhone – they'll give it a unibody design, a larger higher resolution display and a faster processor. Will that be enough? Some feel Apple has not been very innovative with their design elements across their product categories, maintaining a 'if it's not broke, then don't fix it' philosophy. We'll just have to wait and see if Apple will prove these critics wrong.



iPhone 5 mockup